



CARGO WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 25 APRIL 2026 - 24 MAY 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Cargo loss this month was shaped by theft in transit, container theft (inland) and arrest of crime group. Indonesia saw the most consistent reporting, alongside Papua New Guinea and Malaysia. The most serious reached high.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 25 Apr - 24 May 2026	TOTAL RECORDS 23 Cargo Watch this period	HIGHEST SEVERITY High Highest rating this period
TOP ISSUE TYPE Cargo theft in transit 6 records	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY Indonesia 7 records	LATEST INCIDENT 16 May 2026

CARGO THEFT TREND

CARGO SECURITY READ

Route-side and convoy cargo risk showed up this month, covering truck hijackings, container theft, in-transit loss and similar crime. The most recent example is "5 Year Fugitive, Mastermind of Fish Truck Robbery Worth Rp600 Million in Muara Enim Finally Captured While Hiding in OKU Timur", reported 19 May 2026. The countries named most often among these route-side records are Indonesia, Papua New Guinea and Malaysia.

Watch for clustering on specific corridors, repeat operator names in the same week and any escalation from pilferage to coordinated hijack. Insurance loss bulletins and transport-association advisories are the earliest signs that risk on the road is building.

LOGISTICS HUB READ

Logistics-hub risk across warehouses, depots, distribution centres, terminals and bonded storage showed up this month. The most recent example is "Robbery of PT PMP Tin Warehouse; Five Security Guards Tied Up, 10 Suspects Arrested by Joint Team", reported 18 May 2026. The countries named most often among these hub-side records are Indonesia, Australia and Vietnam.

Watch for repeat incidents at the same facility or operator, escalation from pilferage to organised raids, and any insurance-premium movement on affected corridors. Hub-side losses typically precede a hardening of underwriting terms by one to two weeks.

COUNTRY RISK BREAKDOWN

REGION / COUNTRY	CURRENT PATTERN	SEVERITY	OPERATIONAL READ
Indonesia 13 records	Cargo theft in transit, arrest of cargo crime group, warehouse exposure	MODERATE	Road and storage losses appear in roughly equal measure; hold both corridor security and depot access controls. Repeat reporting points to a corridor under sustained pressure.
Papua New Guinea 3 records	Truck hijacking, container theft (inland), route-side exposure	HIGH	Truck and convoy hijacking is the recurring method; corridor selection, escort cover on high-value loads and driver vetting are the first controls. The reports point to organised, targeted activity rather than opportunistic theft.
Malaysia 3 records	Cargo theft in transit, arrest of cargo crime group, route-side exposure	MODERATE	Road-movement losses dominate; harden corridor selection and driver vetting on contracted hauliers before the next high-value move. Repeat reporting points to a corridor under sustained pressure.
Vietnam 2 records	Container theft (inland), arrest of cargo crime group, depot exposure	MODERATE	Container theft in transit leads the route-side picture; seal integrity and matched origin-to-destination handover checks are the priority.
India 2 records	Warehouse theft, truck hijacking	MODERATE	Road and storage losses appear in roughly equal measure; hold both corridor security and depot access controls.
New Zealand 2 records	Arrest of cargo crime group, container theft (inland), route-side exposure	HIGH	Road-movement losses dominate; harden corridor selection and driver vetting on contracted hauliers before the next high-value move. The reports point to organised, targeted activity rather than opportunistic theft.

REGIONAL READ

Indonesia is the main pressure point this month, with a mix of road-movement and storage incidents. Papua New Guinea carries the highest severity (high), consistent with organised, higher-value targeting rather than opportunistic theft. For clients the focus is route security across Papua New Guinea, Malaysia, Vietnam and New Zealand - corridor selection, escorts on high-value loads and driver vetting.

NAMED PORT BREAKDOWN

Not reported.

0 of 31 in-scope records name a specific port

SITUATION

Warehouse, depot and road corridors hold the live exposure this month, with route familiarity and insider risk as the persistent drivers. Indonesia sits at the centre of the recurring geography this month.

WHAT HAPPENED

Cargo crime was reported this month, split across route-side and logistics-hub losses.

Route-side, the most recent example is "5 Year Fugitive, Mastermind of Fish Truck Robbery Worth Rp600 Million in Muara Enim Finally Captured While Hiding in OKU Timur" in Indonesia, reported 19 May 2026.

Hub-side, the most recent example is "Robbery of PT PMP Tin Warehouse; Five Security Guards Tied Up, 10 Suspects Arrested by Joint Team" in Indonesia, reported 18 May 2026.

Losses cluster in Indonesia, Papua New Guinea and Malaysia, pointing to corridors being worked rather than isolated, one-off losses.

WHAT MATTERS

What changed this month for cargo owners and operators sits in two places: route-side incidents that translate directly into inventory loss, fulfilment slippage and insurance-claim exposure; and logistics-hub losses that test warehouse and depot controls, driver and yard-staff vetting, and seal and handover integrity.

The countries named most often this month are Indonesia, Papua New Guinea and Malaysia. Repeat hits in the same country month after month are the clearest early sign that a specific corridor or operator is being worked by an organised crew - that is the point at which insurance bulletins and police alerts typically follow.

For high-value cargo moves the implication is to assume route-side risk has not eased even on a quiet month. Pre-route security reviews, seal and lock integrity checks at handover, and driver-vetting on contracted hauliers are the cheapest mitigation; they only get expensive after a loss.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Run a fresh route review on repeat-loss corridors and re-baseline expected transit risk before the next high-value move.
- Use escort or convoy cover on high-value loads through known-hot lanes; the cost only looks high until a single loss prices it in.

- Tighten depot and warehouse access control - visitor logs, after-hours staffing, CCTV blind spots and perimeter integrity at named hubs.
- Re-baseline driver and yard-staff vetting on contracted hauliers; insider involvement is the consistent thread behind larger losses.
- Enforce seal and lock checks at every handover, with photographic evidence captured and matched at origin and destination.
- Review insurance cover and deductibles on repeat corridors; expect underwriter response within one to two weeks on lanes with recurring activity.
- Confirm incident-reporting and recovery procedures end-to-end - police notification, insurer notification, internal escalation and stock-recovery actions - so the response is rehearsed, not improvised.

WATCH NEXT

- Repeat losses on the same corridor month after month - clearest sign an organised crew is working a specific lane.
- Copycat theft within two weeks of a publicised hijack - one event commonly draws three or four imitators.
- Insider involvement signals - out-of-hours loading, driver or yard-staff turnover coinciding with a loss, seal or lock anomalies.
- Depot access failures, after-hours entries and CCTV outages on the same shift - facility-side organisation rather than opportunistic pilferage.
- Seal or lock failures at handover - leading indicator of a compromised driver, agent or yard handler.
- Fresh arrests, recoveries or charge-sheet filings on prior losses - tells you whether the law-enforcement response is firming or stalling.
- Route displacement away from controlled depots toward weaker ones under cost pressure - common precursor to a fresh round of losses.
- Insurance underwriter bulletins, transport-association advisories and police-alert circulars on affected corridors - the clearest market-side warning.

POLESTAR VIEW

Our assessment is that the larger cargo losses being reported are driven by route familiarity and likely insider knowledge rather than opportunistic crime. The pattern across hijackings, depot raids and seal failures is too consistent to be chance - repeat corridors, named depots and the same methods recur.

The main areas of activity this month are Indonesia, Papua New Guinea and Malaysia.

Route-side hijack risk and logistics-hub theft should be treated as linked exposures rather than separate problems. Inventory that survives the road can still be lost at the depot, and crews working a corridor are often the same crews working a yard at the other end of it.

For business users the focus should sit on four controls: handover discipline (seals, locks, photographic evidence at origin and destination); driver and yard-staff vetting on contracted hauliers; depot discipline on access, staffing and after-hours integrity; and routing that treats repeat-loss corridors as live exposure rather than a default lane choice. These are the controls that hold up over time regardless of how loud or quiet any single month looks.

CARGO INCIDENT CLUSTERS

Severe & High-Severity Clusters

DATE	CATEGORY	INCIDENT	SEVERITY
01 May 2026	Arrest of cargo crime group	Truck hijack on Waikato Expressway near Hamilton, police make arrests not reported. Confidence: Medium Status: Resolved Cargo: FMCG Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	HIGH
27 Apr 2026	Truck hijacking	Truck hijack on Dhaka-Chattogram highway near Cumilla, freight consignment looted not reported. Confidence: Medium Status: Resolved Cargo: FMCG Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	HIGH
27 Apr 2026	Arrest of cargo crime group	Truck hijack on Highlands Highway near Mount Hagen, Western Highlands police make arrests not reported. Confidence: Medium Status: Resolved Cargo: FMCG Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	HIGH

Land-Side Cargo Security

DATE	CATEGORY	INCIDENT	SEVERITY
16 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Angkasa Pura & Soetta Police Tighten Security, Cargo Theft Uncovered Tangerang Confidence: Medium Status: Ongoing Cargo: General Cargo Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE

DATE	CATEGORY	INCIDENT	SEVERITY
15 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Soetta Cargo Theft Scandal: Rp 1 Billion Lululemon Bags Stolen not reported. Confidence: Low Status: Ongoing Cargo: General Cargo Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE
15 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	InJourney Airports Denies Involvement in Cargo Theft by Angkasa Pura Employees not reported. Confidence: Low Status: Ongoing Cargo: General Cargo Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE
13 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Police Bust Cargo Theft Syndicate at Soekarno-Hatta Airport not reported. Confidence: Medium Status: Ongoing Cargo: General Cargo Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE
11 May 2026	Warehouse theft	Industrial-zone warehouse theft in Sorong, police investigating organized crew Sorong Confidence: Medium Status: Ongoing Cargo: General Cargo Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: overnight 1 source	MODERATE
05 May 2026	Container theft (inland)	Cargo container stolen from Sydney freight depot, syndicate suspected not reported. Confidence: Low Status: Unconfirmed Cargo: FMCG Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: overnight 1 source	MODERATE
05 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Other land-based cargo theft - Fuel not reported. Confidence: Low Status: Resolved Cargo: Fuel Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE
05 May 2026	Container theft (inland)	Container theft at Ho Chi Minh City inland freight depot, syndicate suspected not reported. Confidence: Low Status: Unconfirmed Cargo: Electronics Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: overnight 1 source	MODERATE

Port-Related Cargo Security

DATE	CATEGORY	INCIDENT	SEVERITY
29 Apr 2026	Arrest of cargo crime group	Cargo theft syndicate busted after truck hijack in Selangor not reported. Confidence: Medium Status: Resolved Cargo: General Cargo Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE
28 Apr 2026	Arrest of cargo crime group	Truck hijack on QL51 near Bien Hoa, Dong Nai police arrest organised crew not reported. Confidence: Medium Status: Resolved Cargo: General Cargo Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE
27 Apr 2026	Arrest of cargo crime group	Truck hijack on Route 9 near Densavanh, Savannakhet police make arrests not reported. Confidence: Medium Status: Resolved Cargo: FMCG Vessel: not reported. Company: not reported. Time: not reported. 1 source	MODERATE

RECOMMENDED WATCH ITEMS

- Note the disrupted group/method; watch for displacement to nearby routes.
- Brief drivers on high-risk corridor stops; review convoy timing and escort options.
- Track high-value loads in real time; secure overnight staging points.
- Audit warehouse perimeter, CCTV coverage and after-hours access logs.
- Tighten inland container custody handoffs and seal verification.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	TYPE	TITLE	SEVERITY
16 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Angkasa Pura & Soetta Police Tighten Security, Cargo Theft Uncovered Cargo theft in transit in Tangerang, reported 16 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
15 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Soetta Cargo Theft Scandal: Rp 1 Billion Lululemon Bags Stolen Cargo theft in transit, reported 15 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
15 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	InJourney Airports Denies Involvement in Cargo Theft by Angkasa Pura Employees Cargo theft in transit, reported 15 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
13 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Police Bust Cargo Theft Syndicate at Soekarno-Hatta Airport Cargo theft in transit, reported 13 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
12 May 2026	Truck hijacking	Trade-goods truck hijacked outside Lae, Morobe police investigating organised crew Truck hijacking, reported 12 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
11 May 2026	Warehouse theft	Industrial-zone warehouse theft in Sorong, police investigating organized crew Warehouse theft in Sorong, reported 11 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
09 May 2026	Truck hijacking	3 men face 30 years in prison for hijacking a truck carrying Apple products Truck hijacking, reported 09 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW
05 May 2026	Container theft (inland)	Cargo container stolen from Sydney freight depot, syndicate suspected Container theft (inland), reported 05 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
05 May 2026	Container theft (inland)	Container theft at Ho Chi Minh City inland freight depot, syndicate suspected Container theft (inland), reported 05 May 2026, assessed at Moderate severity.	MODERATE
03 May 2026	Cargo theft in transit	Lorry driver robbed, cargo stolen in Johor Cargo theft in transit, reported 03 May 2026, assessed at Low severity.	LOW

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